



Brian Shimkus

SOLUTIONS ENGINEER · AI INTEGRATION

Chicago, IL

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Pre-sales Solutions Engineer specializing in AI integration. I run the full technical sales motion at Insolla, my independent AI consulting practice: discovery, scoping, tailored demos, and proof-of-concept builds. Twelve years delivering customer-facing solutions inside regulated financial organizations taught me to run stakeholder discovery, demo to technical and executive audiences, and integrate enterprise APIs under compliance and security constraints.

SKILLS

PRE-SALES	Technical Discovery, Tailored Demos, Proof of Concept (POC), Proof of Value (POV), Solution Design, Objection Handling, Security Reviews, Executive Presentations, Technical Handoff
AI AND LLM	OpenAI API, LangChain, Pinecone, RAG Architecture, Embeddings, Vector Databases, Structured Outputs, Source Grounding, Evaluation and Guardrails, Prompt Engineering, Python
INTEGRATION	REST APIs, JSON, FastAPI, Salesforce API (OAuth 2.0 JWT), DocuSign API, Webhooks, Node.js, SQL, MySQL, AWS, Git
AUTOMATION	Make.com, n8n, Airtable, Hunter.io, Brevo
FRONT-END	React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, Redux, Tailwind CSS, Jest, Playwright, Vercel

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AI Solutions Engineer

Dec 2025 – Present

Insolla (Independent Consulting Practice)

- Own the complete pre-sales motion as sole technical seller: discovery calls to surface business pain, solution scoping, tailored demos, and proofs of concept that convert prospects into engagements.
- Produce the full pre-sales package: discovery guide, stakeholder map, technical walkthrough, security brief, and POV plan.
- Build proofs of concept against the customer's own systems, integrating CRM, document, and workflow platforms through REST APIs, webhooks, and iPaaS tooling, not canned data.
- Cut a client's social media workflow from 8 hours per week to 10 minutes** with an automated content pipeline, the ROI story that now anchors my discovery conversations.
- Field security reviews on auth, data handling, and retention; implemented OAuth 2.0 JWT auth for production CRM integrations.
- Present technical recommendations to non-technical decision makers; handle objections on hallucination risk, data security, and build versus buy. Ship every solution with source grounding, structured outputs, and human-review paths.

Lead Front-End Developer

Aug 2025 – Dec 2025

TerraFort (Freelance)

- Led design and development of a web and mobile platform at an early-stage startup, executing product initiatives from concept to delivery.
- Owned vendor-facing technical evaluations, scoping and integrating third-party and AI tooling into the product; led collaboration across UX, product, and backend teams.

Senior Front-End Developer

Jul 2024 – Jun 2025

OCC (Contract)

- Ran weekly stakeholder sessions at a systemically important financial market utility, covering goal setting, live progress demos, and open-question resolution across multiple workstreams.
- Independently delivered React and TypeScript solutions from Figma through production across test, QA, and prod environments; implemented Mock Service Worker to unblock front-end work from backend dependencies.

- Led the program that digitalized broker and trader onboarding at a global financial services firm, replacing a compliance-heavy, paper-based workflow with a fully digital process end to end and measurably shortening the onboarding cycle.
- Won adoption from the trading and operations teams whose daily work changed, partnering with compliance and operations stakeholders to scope each rollout.
- Integrated the DocuSign API to digitize document signing across all products.
- Led a five-person front-end team delivering stakeholder-driven solutions in an agile environment; designed and ran the team's internship program.

SELECTED PROJECTS AND CASE STUDIES

Salesforce Intelligence (Flagship Demo Asset)

Retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) assistant enabling natural-language queries over live Salesforce CRM records with grounded, source-cited answers. Built with Python, LangChain, Pinecone, and OpenAI; secured via OAuth 2.0 JWT server-to-server authentication.

Est. impact: Turns a multi-record manual lookup across Cases, Accounts, and Opportunities into one sourced answer in seconds.
brianshimkus.com/case-studies/salesforce-intelligence | rag.insolla.ai | github.com/brianshimkus/Insolla-Salesforce-RAG

Employee Access Lifecycle Assistant

Deterministic identity policy engine that evaluates employee role changes, routes risky access combinations to security review, and provisions through connectors with an append-only audit trail.

Est. impact: Modeled to cut ~52 hours/month of manual IT provisioning effort to policy-driven, auditable decisions.
brianshimkus.com/case-studies/employee-access-lifecycle | github.com/brianshimkus/Employee-Access-Lifecycle-Assistant

POD Recovery Assistant

SOP-grounded workflow that recovers missing proof-of-delivery documents for a freight brokerage, with human approval gates and a full audit trail.

Est. impact: Modeled to cut ~240 hours/month of manual follow-up to a handful of human-reviewed exceptions.
brianshimkus.com/case-studies/pod-recovery-assistant | github.com/brianshimkus/Freight-POD-Recovery

Additional shipped tools: AdvisorFlow AI (meeting-prep briefs from CRM data, built with FastAPI and Next.js), Workflow Analyzer, Contract Analyzer, SOP Generator, List Enricher, and Meeting Notes Analyzer. Each pairs an LLM with structured outputs and a human-review step for a specific operational task.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Senior Front-End Developer / Walker & Dunlop (Contract) — Built Vue.js platform components with Storybook; connected front-end to APIs.	Mar 2020 – Oct 2020
Senior Front-End Developer / ICF — Led front-end lifecycle; standardized web accessibility across projects.	Jan 2019 – Mar 2020
Front-End Developer / TransUnion — Built a Contentful-based CMS for marketing content owners; deployed to AWS.	Jan 2018 – Jan 2019
UX Architect and Front-End Developer / R1 RCM — Partnered with directors to identify product gaps; built working AngularJS prototypes to validate solutions.	Apr 2016 – Jan 2018
Front-End Developer / TimeZoneOne (Contract) — Custom WordPress themes and cross-browser development; clients included Athletico and the Chicago Wolves.	Aug 2015 – Apr 2016
Junior Front-End Developer / Kohactive — Built responsive client sites (Ruby on Rails, SASS); led client meetings with Aon, Manchester United, and The Vitality Group.	Aug 2013 – Aug 2015

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Fine Arts, Graphic Design / Art Institute of Chicago — 3.9 GPA, Dean's List	2013
Instructional Design and Technology / Western Illinois University	2008 – 2010